Charter Amendment Measure F

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Argument Against Measure F

Vote NO on Measure F.

Filling Vacancies. Measure F proposes to change the way elected department heads are replaced in case of a vacancy, and was already rejected by Shasta County voters in 2024. The way that Measure F changes filling a vacancy does not guarantee that the voters will have a say in a replacement, and does not provide any additional transparency compared to current law.

County Charter. County charters serve as foundational documents outlining local governance structures, just like the Constitution does for the United States. Altering our charter through ballot measures should involve extensive public input and meetings with the public. And these measures should be crafted with expert input- not be written with personal pet priorities in mind. The current process worked fine in the past - until the current Board majority was put in place.

Cost of Ballot Measure in Future. Elections are expensive; holding frequent elections for every vacancy could also lead to voter fatigue and low turnout. The special election in November 2025 cost $1.03 million according to the Election Department. Also, the measure doesn't provide detailed guardrails necessary for election integrity-what if there is only one candidate for the vacancy? Would there still be a special million dollar election with only one name on the ballot? That's all county general fund tax dollars.

Ballot Measure Expense. This measure is estimated to cost $20k-$50k just to be on the ballot now. Shasta County needs a deliberate, intentional approach to charter amendments. A new Board member was elected in June, and as of January 2027, the new Board should ensure that changes are made with thorough consideration in the best interest of the community's long-term welfare.

Please vote NO on Measure F.

/s/ Arthur K McBride
/s/ Julie Winter, Nurse Practicioner
/s/ Bradley J Garbutt, Realtor